ABEL KIFLETSION

LEAD FULL-STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Email: abelfis78@gmail.com Phone: (206) 396 6794 Location: Austin, TX

SUMMARY

Lead Full-Stack Software Engineer with 8+ years building robust, scalable systems, most recently owning payments infrastructure for a card-processing and ACH platform. Strong across Kotlin, .NET/C#, and Next.js on Google Cloud (Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, Cloud SQL), with deep experience in payment gateways, card processing, ACH, and PostgreSQL-backed services. Comfortable operating with full autonomy as a technical lead—driving architecture, mentoring engineers, and shipping reliable, observable services end to end. Personal projects are on my GitHub and portfolio.

Core Competencies: Payments Infrastructure · Card Processing · ACH · RTP · 3DS · PCI-DSS · Payment Gateways · Distributed Systems · Microservices · REST API Design · Event-Driven Architecture · Cloud (GCP / AWS) · CI/CD · Observability · Agile / Scrum · Technical Leadership

LinkedIn Profile: https://www.linkedin.com/in/abelfk
Portfolio Website: https://abelfish.github.io/portfolio/
GitHub Profile: https://github.com/abelfish

SKILLS

Operating Systems - Windows, Linux, Virtual Machines
Cloud and Containerization Services - Google Cloud (Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, Cloud SQL, GCS, IAM), AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, DynamoDB, VPC, Lambda), Microsoft Azure, Terraform, CloudFormation, Docker
Programming Languages – Kotlin, Java, C#/.NET, JavaScript, TypeScript, Scala, SQL, HTML, CSS
Frameworks and Libraries – Spring, Spring Boot, .NET / ASP.NET Core, Next.js, React, Node.js, Apache Kafka, Pub/Sub
Build Tools – Maven, Gradle, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, JUnit, Kotest, Cucumber, JMeter, unit & integration testing, Git, GitHub, Docker, Terraform, SonarQube, OpenTelemetry
Databases – PostgreSQL, Cloud SQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis
Scripting – Bash, ZSH
Payments & Domain – Payment gateways, card processing, ACH, RTP, 3DS, PCI-DSS, settlement & payouts, webhooks, idempotency, event-driven architecture, Auth0 (OAuth2 / OIDC, JWT, M2M, MFA, RBAC), REST APIs, microservices, observability (OpenTelemetry, Pino), Agile / Scrum

EXPERIENCE

1. *Apr 2024 – May 2026* PublicSquare (PSQH) - Lead Full-Stack Software Engineer
   Austin, TX

   Stack: Kotlin, .NET/C#, Next.js, PostgreSQL, GCP (Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, Cloud SQL), Auth0 (OAuth2/OIDC, JWT, M2M, MFA), OpenTelemetry, Pino, REST APIs, microservices

   - Served as technical lead with full autonomy over a suite of payments services, owning architecture and delivery across a Kotlin and .NET/C# backend on Google Cloud (Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, Cloud SQL) with a Next.js frontend.
   - Designed and built core payments-gateway flows—card processing, ACH, and Payment Transfer Intents—including state machines, settlement and payout handling, and idempotent webhook processing, supporting $400M+ across 800K+ transactions at a 98.1% success rate.
   - Supported Auth0 identity and access management across the Next.js frontend and .NET/Kotlin microservices—configuring applications, machine-to-machine (M2M) authentication for service-to-service calls, admin role-based access control, custom claim transformation via Actions, and multi-factor authentication (MFA)—to secure sensitive payment endpoints.
   - Added distributed observability to the Next.js / GCP Cloud Run stack with OpenTelemetry, Pino structured logging, and trace correlation, reducing incident diagnosis time by 26% and improving visibility into payment failures.

- Diagnosed and resolved production-critical issues including concurrency bugs, webhook batch-processing failures, and payout-API timeouts, hardening the reliability of high-throughput PostgreSQL-backed services.
- Planned and led a production domain/subdomain migration, coordinating DNS TTL, TLS, webhook allowlisting, and merchant communication to ensure zero-downtime cutover.
- Authored developer-facing API documentation (Payment Transfer Intents, card payment flows, state diagrams) and mentored 3 engineers, raising the team's consistency and onboarding speed.

2. *Sept 2023 – Feb 2024* Chewy Inc - Software Engineer (Contractor)
   Bellevue, Washington

   Stack: Java, Spring Boot, Apache Kafka, microservices, REST APIs, caching

   - Helped design, develop, test and document new features and enhancements for the loyalty program.
   - Implemented, documented, and tested the logic to evaluate loyalty program promotions within the core promotions engine.
   - Worked on caching of loyalty customer information by listening to Kafka topic to optimize performance.
3. *Jul 2019 - Aug 2022* ADE SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS – Full-Stack Software Engineer
   Nairobi, Kenya

   Stack: Java, Spring Boot, React, Angular, Docker, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, REST APIs, microservices, CI/CD

   - Built scalable web applications for finance and healthcare clients using Spring Boot, Docker, React, Angular, and MongoDB, with Spring Data modules (Hibernate, JPA, REST, Elasticsearch).
   - Led the migration of 5+ monolithic applications to cloud-hosted microservices using Spring Boot and REST APIs.
   - Introduced test-driven development into the SDLC, cutting development and testing time by 48% and reducing long-term costs by 60%+.
4. *Sept 2015 - Jul 2019* ASMARA IMPORT & EXPORT - Java Developer
   Asmara, Eritrea
   - Delivered multiple concurrent software projects that directly grew the company's marginal profits by ~24% year over year.
   - Mentored 21 new recruits over three years.
   - Built an application that streamlined the import/export process—managing shipments, inventory, and customs clearance—opening new business lines for the company.

EDUCATION

1. 2022 – 2023 Master's in Computer Science - *Maharishi International University*
   Fairfield, IA
   GPA: 4.00
2. 2011 – 2016 Bachelor's in Computer Science - *Eritrea Institute of Technology*
   Asmara, Eritrea
   GPA: 3.7